our peril. But if we get it right, it can facilitate the building of capacities that trigger their own virtuous cycle.

An active debate is underway on the nature of India's economic engagement with the world. No one seriously doubts the reality of globalization or questions the need to interact with other economies. The key issue is the terms negotiated by India. Foreign-trade liberalization should not be practised at the cost of fair competition in our own markets. And unfortunately, that is exactly what we have seen in the past. The subsidizing of production and denial of market access in other parts of the world have made it very difficult to compete. If critical production is no longer viable, then it is not a matter of trade policy but a concern of national security. Let us be clear: India can only be consequential abroad if it has adequate capacities at home. It is not our fate to be just a market for goods or a generator of data for others. A rising India will only really advance when it is an *atmanirbhar* Bharat.

India's emergence on the world stage has been an exceptionally eventful journey. And external challenges have been as formidable as the internal consolidation process. The traumatic Partition left consequences, some of which are being addressed only now. And through all this, those opposed to the re-emergence of India have done their best to make that process difficult. Terrorism, radicalism and separatism have been used on multiple occasions. We have been through difficult years but came through stronger due to the sacrifices of our people. The takeaway is the need to deter our diversity being projected as fault lines. Strengthening national sentiment, by itself, may not discourage such continuing endeavours. That we are an open society also means that there are more opportunities for mischief. Eternal vigilance, in our case, is not just the price of liberty but of national unity as well.

India's rise in the global order is not merely an ascendance on the ladder of power. It is simultaneously a transformation of a civilizational society into a modern nation-state. Securing borders and improving governance are no longer enough; they are just the foundation on which many other capabilities need to be developed. As is often the case in India, different eras will coexist, even in the domain of security. In the coming period, our concerns will gradually become more global. But we must not lack the boldness to seek some of the solutions there as well. Just as we prepare for contingencies at home, we must develop habits of cooperation abroad.